

DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

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Introduction

This project is part of the Digital Literacy course, where I take on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. The aim of this project is to develop essential digital skills and promote awareness about the responsible and effective use of digital technologies.

The project consists of five tasks that focus on different aspects of digital literacy, including creating an infographic, building a digital portfolio, exploring coding platforms, practicing professional communication, and understanding cybercrime awareness. Each task involves practical implementation using modern digital tools.

Through this project, I gained hands-on experience with various platforms and improved my technical, communication, and analytical skills. It also helped me understand the importance of maintaining a professional digital presence and staying safe online.

Task 1:

Digital Literacy Infographic

For this task, I designed a one-page visual resource using **Canva**. My infographic focuses on three pillars: defining digital literacy, identifying essential academic tools (like GitHub and Google Workspace), and maintaining safe internet practices. I chose a clean, professional layout to ensure the information is accessible to my peers. The design highlights the importance of professional online identities on platforms like LinkedIn. One interesting aspect was exploring Canva's icon library to represent abstract concepts like "cybersecurity" visually. The most challenging part was condensing complex topics into short, impactful bullet points without losing the core message. This exercise improved my ability to communicate technical information through visual design.

Task 2:

Digital Portfolio

I established my professional foundation by setting up profiles on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **HackerRank**. GitHub serves as a repository for my coding projects, while LinkedIn allows me to connect with the academic and professional community. On HackerRank, I focus on improving my problem-solving logic. My GitHub profile now includes a customized README that lists my branch, year, and my specific goal to master Python programming for data-driven projects. On LinkedIn, I have updated my education section to reflect my current B.Tech degree at VIT Bhopal. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms to document my learning journey, showcase my technical growth, and eventually apply for summer internships.

Task 3:

Coding & Collaboration Platform

In this task, I practiced both technical and collaborative skills. I used **HackerRank** to complete the 'Python Introduction' challenge, which helped me familiarize myself with online coding environments. For the collaboration component, I developed a 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using **Google Forms**. The quiz features five questions, including multiple-choice and short-answer formats, designed to test my batchmates' knowledge of online safety. I also integrated the form with a Google Sheet to manage real-time responses. These tools are vital for my academic career as they facilitate peer-to-peer learning and efficient data management during group projects.

Task 4:

Email Etiquette & Communication

Digital communication requires a high degree of professionalism to avoid misunderstandings. I drafted two emails: one requesting an assignment extension and another inquiring about an internship, ensuring both had clear subject lines and polite sign-offs. I also developed a 10-point social media checklist to help students maintain a responsible digital footprint. A situation where poor communication causes issues is when a student sends a "txt-speak" message to a professor; this often leads to the request being ignored due to a perceived lack of respect. Learning these structures ensures my professional requests are taken seriously.

Social Media Checklist (Task 4 Part B):

- **Do:** Set profiles to private to control your digital footprint.
- **Do:** Use strong, unique passwords and enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA).
- **Do:** Verify information and sources before sharing posts to avoid misinformation.
- **Do:** Keep your "Education" and "Experience" sections updated and professional.
- **Do:** Respect others' privacy by asking before posting photos of them.
- **Don't:** Post sensitive personal data like your home address or phone number.
- **Don't:** Share photos of official documents like your college ID or admit cards.
- **Don't:** Engage in cyberbullying or use offensive language in comments.
- **Don't:** Click on suspicious "clickbait" links or "free prize" messages.
- **Don't:** Post unprofessional content that could be seen by future internship coordinators.

Task 5:

Cybercrime Awareness

While researching **Phishing**, I was surprised by how sophisticated "spear-phishing" has become, often using personal details to appear legitimate. It made me realize that even tech-savvy students can be victims if they aren't vigilant. One habit I will change is my approach to links: I will now hover over every URL to verify the destination before clicking, especially for UPI-related messages. I have compiled a checklist that includes the **National Cyber Crime Portal (1930)** to ensure my peers know exactly where to turn if they encounter fraud.

Conclusion: This project provided valuable insights into digital literacy and its importance in today's world. It helped me develop practical skills in design, coding, communication, and cybersecurity. I learned how to build a professional digital presence and use online tools effectively for academic and professional growth. The tasks also highlighted the importance of responsible digital behavior and staying safe online. Overall, this project has prepared me to become a more confident and responsible digital user.

References

1. **Canva:** (Used for Task 1 Infographic).
2. **GitHub:** (Used for Repository and Task 2 Portfolio).
3. **HackerRank:** (Used for Task 3 Coding Challenge).
4. **Google Forms:** (Used for Task 3 Collaboration).
5. **National Cyber Crime Portal:** [suspicious link removed] (Used for Task 5 Research).